


The Reciprocal Opening Window

A Narrow, Symmetrical Framework to Break the Current Deadlock
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Contents

The Situation in Six Lines

One Rule

Joint Technical Secretariat

Three Symmetrical Steps

Step One: The Simultaneous Opening

Step Two: The Verification Window

Step Three: The Stabilisation Extension

What Iran Gets

What the United States Gets

Shields Against Spoilers

Implementation Matrix

Technical Annexes

If Talks Stall: The Emergency Fallback

The Situation in Six Lines

1. **Uranium:** Iran holds roughly 400 kg of uranium enriched to 60%, enough for breakout to weapons-grade within weeks. The IAEA has not verified any facility for over eight months.
2. **Sanctions:** Iran's economy is in crisis — currency collapse, rolling blackouts, inflation above 35%. Tehran needs hard currency and oil-market access.
3. **The Gap:** Iran has offered to *downblend* (dilute) its 60% stockpile, a real concession. Washington insists on *zero domestic enrichment* or full export of all material.
4. **Hormuz:** Oil trades above \$107/barrel. The Strait of Hormuz is a pressure point for both sides — Iran can disrupt it; the world economy pays the price.
5. **Trust:** Neither side believes the other will keep its word. Both need a mechanism that moves them *simultaneously*, so neither moves alone.
6. **Time:** The ceasefire is described as on "life support." Every week without progress raises the risk of reversion to military confrontation.

One Rule

**Nothing happens unless both things happen at the same time.
Iran does not move first. The United States does not move first.
Every obligation is paired with a reciprocal obligation, verified
simultaneously.**

This document proposes a **narrow, three-step reciprocal window** measured in weeks, not years. Each step is small enough to be implemented quickly, concrete enough to be verified independently, and paired so that neither side advances unilaterally.

The scope is deliberately limited to the nuclear file. Regional issues — missiles, proxies, maritime security — are explicitly excluded from this window. They can be addressed in a second track only after this window demonstrates that reciprocal motion is possible.

Joint Technical Secretariat

Location: Muscat, Oman (neutral jurisdiction, existing diplomatic infrastructure)
Composition: Six technical liaisons — three nominated by each party. Liaisons are non-political civil servants or retired inspectors, not ministers or spokespeople.
Mandate: Operational management of the 24-hour window protocol, IAEA data relay, sensor dashboard maintenance, and dispute logging.

The Secretariat operates on a **pre-agreed Protocol Manual** signed before Day One. Its functions:

- **24-Hour Window Protocol:** Neither announcement is released until the Secretariat confirms both are logged and timestamps them.
- **Sensor Dashboard:** Live portal aggregating IAEA reporting, oil waiver flags, and banking clearances. All data visible to both parties in real time.
- **Dispute Log:** Time-stamped concerns shared simultaneously. No unilateral declarations.
- **Escrow Administration:** Holds the 40% performance reserve; releases only upon IAEA-certified moratorium completion.

The Secretariat has **no political authority** — it verifies, logs, and relays only.

Three Symmetrical Steps

1 The Simultaneous Opening *Days 1-14*

Baseline Reconciliation (Days 1-5): Before any oil waiver activates, the IAEA audits the 60% stockpile history. Iran provides production records and cascade logs; the IAEA cross-references against its own data. Oil sanctions suspension activates only after "Baseline Verified" confirmation. Discrepancies exceeding 5% are logged as VIU and resolved under the 14-day protocol before relief proceeds.

What Iran does (announced simultaneously with US action):

- Submits to the IAEA, within 72 hours, a complete written inventory of all enriched uranium stockpiles (locations, quantities, enrichment levels, chemical forms) at all four declared enrichment facilities.
- Restores IAEA inspector access to all four declared facilities within 7 days, including the Isfahan Nuclear Technology Center.
- Commits in writing to begin downblending all uranium enriched above 20% to a maximum of 19.75% within 14 days, with IAEA cameras recording the process in real time.
- Permits the IAEA to verify the history of the 60% stockpile during the 5-day Baseline Reconciliation Period before any sanctions relief activates.

What the United States does (announced simultaneously with Iranian action):

- Issues executive waivers authorising the release of \$2.5 billion in frozen Iranian assets held in third-country accounts, restricted to medical supplies, agricultural commodities, and civilian aviation safety parts. Once these funds are spent on verified humanitarian goods, their value is non-reversible — Iran retains the goods regardless of subsequent events.
- Suspends for 90 days the enforcement of secondary sanctions on purchasers of Iranian crude oil, up to a volume ceiling of 1.0 million barrels per day (reported transparently to the third-party clearing account managed by the Secretariat).
- Issues a public statement affirming that the United States accepts Iran's right to peaceful nuclear energy under the NPT and that this window does not seek regime change.

Verification: The Joint Technical Secretariat confirms both announcements are issued within the same 24-hour window before either takes effect. The IAEA Baseline Verification must be issued before the oil waiver activates.

2 The Verification Window *Weeks 3-8*

Automated Stepback Trigger: The Secretariat's sensor dashboard monitors IAEA reporting in real time. If the IAEA portal shows "Down" for more than 10 consecutive days, the corresponding oil waiver is automatically suspended by the clearing bank. Alerts fire at Day 7 and Day 10. When the portal resumes "Active" for 5 consecutive days, the waiver reactivates automatically. No political decision required.

Data Relay Protocol (Portal Dark Scenarios): If the IAEA portal goes dark due to an external technical fault (regional internet outage, third-party cyberattack, or infrastructure failure), the 10-day countdown is paused if the IAEA provides manual, verified telemetry or physical data dumps to the Muscat Secretariat within 48 hours. The Secretariat logs the external cause and the manual data receipt; the Stepback clock freezes until the portal resumes or the 48-hour manual delivery window closes. This prevents Iran from being unfairly penalised for infrastructure failures outside its control.

Hard-Coded Banking Channel: The Designated Commercial Bank (UBS AG, Zurich, or Qatar National Bank, Doha) processes all medical and agricultural transactions under pre-issued U.S. Treasury comfort letters. Transactions clear mechanically per the published compliance protocol.

What Iran does:

- Downblending of all material above 20% proceeds under continuous IAEA monitoring. IAEA publishes weekly confirmation that downblending is active.
- Allows installation of IAEA containment and surveillance measures at Natanz and Fordow (cameras, seals, tamper-evident enclosures).
- Provides IAEA access to centrifuge assembly workshops for a one-time inventory verification.
- **Net inventory freeze:** During the downblending phase (Weeks 3-8), Iran's total enriched uranium inventory across all declared facilities cannot increase beyond the reconciled baseline established during the Baseline Reconciliation. Any new enrichment output must be matched by equivalent downblending of material above 20%, verified weekly by the IAEA.

What the United States does:

- Authorises the Designated Commercial Bank to process Iranian medical and agricultural transactions under the pre-issued Treasury comfort letters.
- Issues a 90-day renewable general license permitting the export of civilian aircraft spare parts to Iran (specific approved part numbers listed in Annex C). Shipments clear U.S. Customs under the general license; no individual license required.
- Suspends threatened tariffs on countries trading with Iran for the duration of the Verification Window.

The "Stepback Line": Either side can step back (pause) its obligations if the IAEA confirms the other side has failed to perform for more than 10 consecutive days. Stepping back by one side automatically releases the other from its corresponding obligations. There is no penalty for stepping back; the window simply freezes until both sides resume. This is not a rollback of prior gains — it is a reversible pause. The automated trigger removes the need for political accusations.

3 The Stabilisation Extension *Months 3-6*

Trigger: IAEA confirms that all uranium previously enriched above 20% has been downblended to 19.75% or below, and the United States has maintained its sanctions relief for 60 consecutive days.

72-Hour Administrative Transition: Upon IAEA certification of the trigger conditions, both sides have 72 hours to issue their Step Three operational directives simultaneously through the Secretariat. The oil escrow (60/40), enrichment cap, and centrifuge moratorium all activate at the same timestamp. No party implements unilaterally. This prevents a diplomatic vacuum between verification and activation.

Oil Revenue Escrow (60/40 Split): Revenue is deposited into a monitored escrow at the Designated Commercial Bank, denominated in EUR, RMB, or AED (non-USD). Sixty percent is released monthly for civilian imports. Forty percent is held by the Secretariat as a **performance reserve**, released only upon IAEA-certified completion of the 12-month centrifuge moratorium. If broken, the 40% is forfeited to an international humanitarian fund — not retained by the United States. Escrowed funds are held under Omani sovereign immunity and are immune to judicial seizure or third-party attachment.

Pre-Authorised Stockpile Disposition: Conversion to fuel plates for the Tehran Research Reactor is the default path. Iran begins conversion under IAEA monitoring within 30 days of Step Three activation. Alternatives (domestic IAEA-sealed storage, third-country escrow) must be declared by Day 60 with a transition plan. Absent notification, fuel plate conversion proceeds.

What Iran does:

- Caps all enrichment activity at 3.67% for a renewable 6-month period, with IAEA continuous monitoring.
- Agrees to a 12-month moratorium on installing new centrifuge cascades at any declared facility. Completion is certified by the IAEA and triggers release of the 40% performance reserve.
- Begins conversion of the downblended stockpile to fuel plates for the Tehran Research Reactor under IAEA monitoring, as the pre-authorised default disposition path.

What the United States does:

- Issues a 6-month general license for Iran to export up to 1.5 million barrels per day, with revenue deposited into the escrow account under the 60/40 split mechanism.
- Suspends designation of additional Iranian financial institutions for the duration of the extension.

- Convenes, with EU and Gulf partners, a technical working group on long-term civilian nuclear cooperation framework (fuel supply guarantees, medical isotope collaboration).

What Iran Gets

IMMEDIATE (DAYS 1-14)

- **\$2.5 billion** in frozen assets released for medical, agricultural, and aviation safety use. Once spent on verified humanitarian goods, this value is non-reversible.
- **90-day suspension** of secondary sanctions on oil buyers (up to 1.0 mb/d), managed through the automated clearing mechanism
- **Public US affirmation** of Iran's NPT right to peaceful nuclear energy and non-interference in domestic governance
- **Baseline Reconciliation** ensures the inventory starting point is fair and transparent, not a trap

SHORT-TERM (WEEKS 3-8)

- Designated Commercial Bank (with Treasury comfort letters) processes **medical and agricultural trade** mechanically, not case-by-case
- Civilian aviation spare parts (**pre-approved part numbers, Annex C**) clear customs under general license
- **No new tariffs** on Iran's trading partners during the window
- **Automated alerts** at Day 7 and Day 10 of any interruption, preventing surprise cutoffs

MEDIUM-TERM (MONTHS 3-6)

- Oil export ceiling raised to **1.5 million barrels per day**
- **60% of oil revenue** released monthly for civilian imports; **40% held as performance reserve** and released upon centrifuge moratorium completion
- Downblended material converted to **fuel plates for the Tehran Research Reactor** — a civilian use, not a surrender
- Pathway to **fuel supply guarantees** and civilian nuclear cooperation
- Regime security: explicit US statement that the agreement is **not a prelude to regime change**

What Iran can tell its domestic audience: "We did not surrender our nuclear programme. We retained enrichment capability. We secured frozen funds, oil markets, and a US guarantee against regime change. The 60% material became fuel plates for our research reactor — civilian use, not seizure. The banking channel has pre-approved Treasury letters."

What the United States Gets

IMMEDIATE (DAYS 1-14)

- **Complete inventory** of all enriched uranium stockpiles submitted to IAEA within 72 hours, with Baseline Reconciliation cross-checking against the 8-month gap
- **Physical inspector access** restored to all four enrichment facilities within 7 days
- **Written commitment** to downblend all material above 20% within 14 days
- **Automated suspension** of oil waivers if IAEA reporting goes dark for 10 days — no political fight required

SHORT-TERM (WEEKS 3-8)

- **Continuous IAEA monitoring** of downblending operations in real time
- **Containment and surveillance** installed at Natanz and Fordow
- **Centrifuge assembly inventory** — one-time verified count
- **Automated Stepback alerts** at Day 7 and Day 10 remove the need for accusatory public statements

MEDIUM-TERM (MONTHS 3-6)

- **Enrichment capped at 3.67%** for 6 months, continuously monitored
- **12-month moratorium** on new centrifuge installation, with 40% performance reserve forfeited if broken
- **Stockpile disposition** converted to fuel plates — near-breakout material transformed into unusable reactor fuel
- **IAEA continuity of knowledge** restored after an 8-month gap, with full reconciliation audit
- **Cyber shield** protects nuclear and financial infrastructure from digital sabotage during the window

What the United States can tell its domestic audience: "Every sanction relief is paired with a verified nuclear constraint. Iran's 60% stockpile becomes fuel plates under live camera feed. Inspector access restored. Breakout time extended. The 40% escrow means Iran gets full revenue only after 12 months of compliance. No sunset clause. If Iran stops, we stop — automatically."

Shields Against Spoilers

A narrow reciprocal window lives or dies on its ability to absorb shocks from domestic opponents, regional actors, and unexpected events. The following safeguards are built into the design:

SHIELD 1: THE SIMULTANEOUS ANNOUNCEMENT PROTOCOL

Neither side announces its steps until the Joint Technical Secretariat confirms both are logged and ready. The 24-hour window protocol timestamps both submissions and issues a joint release only when both are within the window. This prevents either side from being accused of "moving first" or "caving." Both sides save face.

SHIELD 2: THE AUTOMATED STEPBACK LINE

Either side can step back (pause) its obligations if the IAEA confirms the other side has failed to perform for 10 consecutive days. The Secretariat's sensor dashboard automates this: the clearing bank suspends the corresponding oil waiver automatically when the IAEA portal shows "Down" for 10 days. No political decision, no accusatory press conference. The window simply pauses. Prior gains remain in place; nothing is undone. Automated alerts fire at Day 7 and Day 10, giving both sides warning before any suspension takes effect. When the IAEA portal shows "Active" for 5 consecutive days, the waiver automatically reactivates.

SHIELD 3: VIU CLASSIFICATION + 14-DAY MEDIATION

Ambiguous data (missing cameras, inventory discrepancies, delayed access) is classified **Verification Integrity Uncertain (VIU)**, not "violation." VIU triggers investigation, not punishment. Each VIU item must be resolved within **14 days** or it automatically escalates to a formal mediation track where technical experts (not politicians) determine if the issue is fixable. Only confirmed, intentional cessation of cooperation escalates beyond the Stepback Line. This prevents the window from freezing indefinitely over technical hiccups.

SHIELD 4: THE NON-REVERSIBILITY CLAUSE

The \$2.5 billion in released assets, once spent on verified humanitarian goods, is non-reversible. Iran retains the value of goods already delivered regardless of subsequent events. This ensures Iran is not penalised for goods already traded if the window later pauses.

SHIELD 5: REGIONAL ACTOR CONTAINMENT

The window explicitly excludes missiles and regional proxies. This prevents hardliners in Tehran from being squeezed by allies and prevents Washington from being pressured by regional partners. The narrow nuclear scope keeps the window manageable. With oil above \$107/barrel, both sides share an incentive to prevent Hormuz disruption, creating positive-sum framing.

SHIELD 6: THE CYBER DE-ESCALATION SIDE-LETTER

Both sides commit to refraining from offensive cyber operations against nuclear facilities and financial clearing systems for the duration of the window. A **cyber violation** is defined strictly as an active digital intrusion that causes operational disruption, data falsification, or physical damage to the listed networks. This includes: (a) cyberattacks on enrichment facility control systems, IAEA sensor networks, or camera feeds; (b) cyberattacks on the Designated Commercial Bank, escrow accounts, or the Secretariat's sensor dashboard; (c) supply-chain compromises of spare parts or banking software. Passive network scanning, routine intelligence collection, and defensive hardening do not constitute violations. Violations are reported to the Secretariat and treated as Stepback events.

Implementation Matrix

Who	What	When	Verified By	If Not Done
Iran	Submit complete uranium inventory to IAEA	Day 3	IAEA confirms receipt	US waivers do not activate
Iran	Baseline Reconciliation audit of 60% stockpile history	Days 1-5	IAEA "Baseline Verified" to Secretariat	Oil suspension does not activate
United States	Issue humanitarian waivers (\$2.5bn, non-reversible once spent)	Day 1-3 (simultaneous)	Secretariat confirms issuance	Iran access not required
Iran	Restore IAEA facility access	Day 7	IAEA confirms on-site	Automated Stepback at Day 10
US	Suspend secondary sanctions (1.0 mb/d)	Day 6 (contingent on Secretariat receiving IAEA "Baseline Verified")	Secretariat confirms IAEA log	Iran downblending void
Iran	Begin downblending >20% material	Day 14	IAEA real-time cameras	Automated Stepback at Day 10
US	Open Designated Bank for medical/ag trade	Week 3	SWIFT data	Iran may pause containment
Iran	Install IAEA cameras and seals	Weeks 3-8	IAEA confirms	US may pause aviation license
US	Authorise aviation spare parts (Annex C)	Week 3	Export registry	Iran may restrict IAEA access
Both	Cyber non-interference commitment	Day 1 onwards	Secretariat monitoring	Treated as Stepback event

Iran	Cap enrichment at 3.67%; begin fuel plate conversion	Month 3	IAEA continuous monitoring	Escrow 60% suspended
US	1.5 mb/d license + 60/40 escrow	Month 3	Clearing account	Iran cap not binding
Iran	Centrifuge moratorium (12 months)	Month 3-15	IAEA quarterly reports	40% reserve forfeited to ICRC
Secretariat	Release 40% reserve to Iran	Month 15	IAEA certifies moratorium	Forfeited to humanitarian fund
Both	Technical working group	Month 4-6	Published communiques	Window continues

Technical Annexes

ANNEX A: DESIGNATED COMMERCIAL BANK

Primary: UBS AG, Zurich. **Alternative:** Qatar National Bank (QNB), Doha.

Comfort Letters: Pre-issued by U.S. Treasury OFAC before Day One, confirming transactions under the compliance protocol will not trigger secondary sanctions.

Compliance Protocol: Published whitelist of approved categories (medical, agricultural, aviation parts). Matching transactions clear mechanically.

ANNEX B: OIL REVENUE ESCROW 60/40 MECHANISM

Escrow Holder: Joint Technical Secretariat, operating under the sovereign jurisdiction of the Sultanate of Oman (Muscat).

60%: Transferred monthly for civilian imports. **40%:** Held as performance reserve, released only upon IAEA-certified completion of the 12-month centrifuge moratorium. If broken, forfeited to ICRC humanitarian programmes — not retained by the US.

Judicial Protection: Both parties agree that all escrowed funds are legally held under the sovereign immunity of the Sultanate of Oman and are entirely immune to domestic judicial seizure, civil litigation attachment, or third-party claims in any jurisdiction. Neither party nor its courts may attach, freeze, or seize escrowed assets.

Currency: All oil revenue deposits and escrow accounts are denominated and cleared exclusively in Euros (EUR), Chinese Yuan (RMB), or Emirati Dirhams (AED). USD clearing through Fedwire is excluded to prevent unilateral structural control.

Both parties receive monthly escrow statements.

ANNEX C: APPROVED AVIATION PARTS

Pre-approved under 90-day general license (no individual review): **Airbus A300/A310** (landing gear ATA 32, navigation ATA 34, APU ATA 49); **Boeing 737** (flight controls ATA 27, CFM56 fan blades ATA 72, pitot-static ATA 34); **ATR 72** (propellers ATA 61, gear ATA 32); **General** (tyres, brakes, batteries, fire extinguishers, oxygen, ELTs).

Exclusions: No encryption-capable avionics, night vision, or military-grade materials.

ANNEX D: BASELINE RECONCILIATION PROTOCOL

Cross-references Iran's inventory against IAEA historical data before sanctions relief activates:

1. Iran provides IAEA access to production records and cascade logs for the 8-month gap.
2. IAEA compares declared quantities against its own estimates.
3. Discrepancies within 5%: IAEA issues "Baseline Verified."
4. Discrepancies exceed 5%: logged as VIU, resolved under 14-day VIU protocol.
5. Oil sanctions suspension activates only after "Baseline Verified."

If Talks Stall: The Emergency Fallback

If the full three-step window cannot be launched, a smaller "Minimum Viable Opening" should still be pursued. This stripped-down version requires no trust and minimal negotiation:

Option A: The Custody Exchange

Iran places its 60% enriched uranium stockpile under IAEA physical custody and seal at a declared facility. In exchange, the United States releases \$500 million in frozen medical/humanitarian funds. No enrichment cap. No political commitments. Just a physical custody arrangement for a financial release.

Option B: The Humanitarian Parallel

The United States authorises a one-time \$1 billion humanitarian channel (food, medicine, civilian aviation safety) through the Designated Commercial Bank. Simultaneously, Iran allows a one-time IAEA physical inventory verification at one declared enrichment facility of its choosing. No ongoing obligations. Just a single exchange.

Option C: The Technical Talks Track

If even the above are politically impossible, both sides should authorise technical experts (not politicians) to meet in Vienna under IAEA auspices. Their mandate: to agree on a standardised reporting format for Iran's nuclear material, a baseline set of IAEA access modalities, and verification procedures to maintain continuity of knowledge during any diplomatic pause. This produces no political agreement but rebuilds the technical infrastructure for future diplomacy.

The goal of the Emergency Fallback is not to solve the nuclear dispute. It is to prove that reciprocal motion between these two parties is still physically possible — and to create a small pool of verified facts from which a larger agreement can later be built.